

Candidate Statement for Christopher Wang

Sydney Young Engineers Branch

I'm in my final year of my undergraduate studies and I've spent the past few years giving back to my student community, looking to provide meaningful professional, personal and academic development opportunities. To continue my personal mission of giving back to the community after graduation is why I'm expressing my interest in joining the Sydney Young Engineers Branch in 2022 as a general committee member.

I've been very lucky in my university career to have been entrusted by my peers to take on various leadership roles and it's these experiences of event planning and initiative organisation that I will bring to the Young Engineers team in 2022. My experiences range from leading the design development of a UNSW VIVID Submission to now being the current president of UNSW's largest constituent engineering society, the Civil Engineering and Environmental Society (CEVSOC). In this role, I strive to influence the future of the industry through developing this next generation of engineers into well rounded individuals.

As president, I manage a team of 57, embedding my vision and foresight throughout all our projects. This past year, my team and I have led the way for over 50 unique initiatives, including a peer mentoring program, an industry mentoring program and an orientation camp for our student base of over 1800+. Our events range from career development, academic workshops, socials, sports and philanthropic drives. In particular, I'm most proud of our new Diversity and Inclusion portfolio that I founded in my term. We have launched a podcast exploring social issues within the industry, and have organised events championing women in construction, pride in engineering and international students. These events are all in collaboration with leading firms to help bridge these gaps as I'm a firm believer that you cannot be what you cannot see. I hope to bring this commitment to being future ready to the role as a general committee member within the Young Engineers Sydney Branch.

I believe there is a strong synergy with my experience at CEVSOC to what the Young Engineers Committee strives for. I will leverage this to help with event planning, marketing and delivery throughout the year to create a meaningful program to deliver to young engineers throughout Sydney.

Professionally, I've been an assistant project officer working client side at the Department of Defence in the Capital Facilities and Infrastructure. Next year, I'm looking forward to being a sustainability engineer within WSP's building and properties business where I will continue to chase my passion of creating better places and a better Sydney. Whilst I am young in my career, I am extremely keen to work with the committee to create amazing events and meet some wonderful people who share this commitment to giving back.

Community leadership is a big part of how I aim to achieve my goals of improving society and lives. I have a commitment to helping others achieve success where I believe those who are as passionate about their work are the ones who can meaningfully help create a better future. Next year, I want to continue to be a part of the process of helping others learn more of their industries and to find meaningful career paths for them through the Sydney Young Engineers Branch so that we can all make our stamp on the world.